



similar and generics, but AstraZeneca is investing in high-end therapies. Are there India-specific affordability models or collaborations to widen access?

16 | A: Our strategy is not only to innovate but also to ensure that innovation is accessible. In India, enabling access to new therapies is central to our purpose. We continue to run patient assistance programmes and initiatives to help more patients receive treatment.

We also see value in partnerships. We have collaborated with several Indian pharma companies in the past and remain open to similar partnerships in the future.

Q: What about expanding the manufacturing base in India?

A: Manufacturing has been part of our India footprint for decades. While there are no immediate plans to add capacity, we review the landscape regularly. Our commitment to India remains strong.

Q: How is AstraZeneca using AI and technology in its operations and drug discovery?

A: We are investing significantly in AI across the organisation. In R&D, AI can help shorten discovery timelines by optimising candidate selection. It is already being used to streamline processes.

We are also improving digital literacy across our teams through internal learning programmes focused on understanding AI's impact on healthcare. Additionally, we are collaborating with partners

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such as Qure.ai to use AI for detecting diseases such as lung cancer early.

Q: The government recently announced price cuts on several medicines. How do you view policy changes and the regulatory environment in India?

A: We welcome the government's efforts to improve access to medicines. Recent GST reductions and customs duty changes are positive moves that will directly help patients.

Implementation can take time, but that is natural given the sector's size. We remain committed to partnering with the government to streamline regulatory processes and accelerate drug availability. **BT**

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